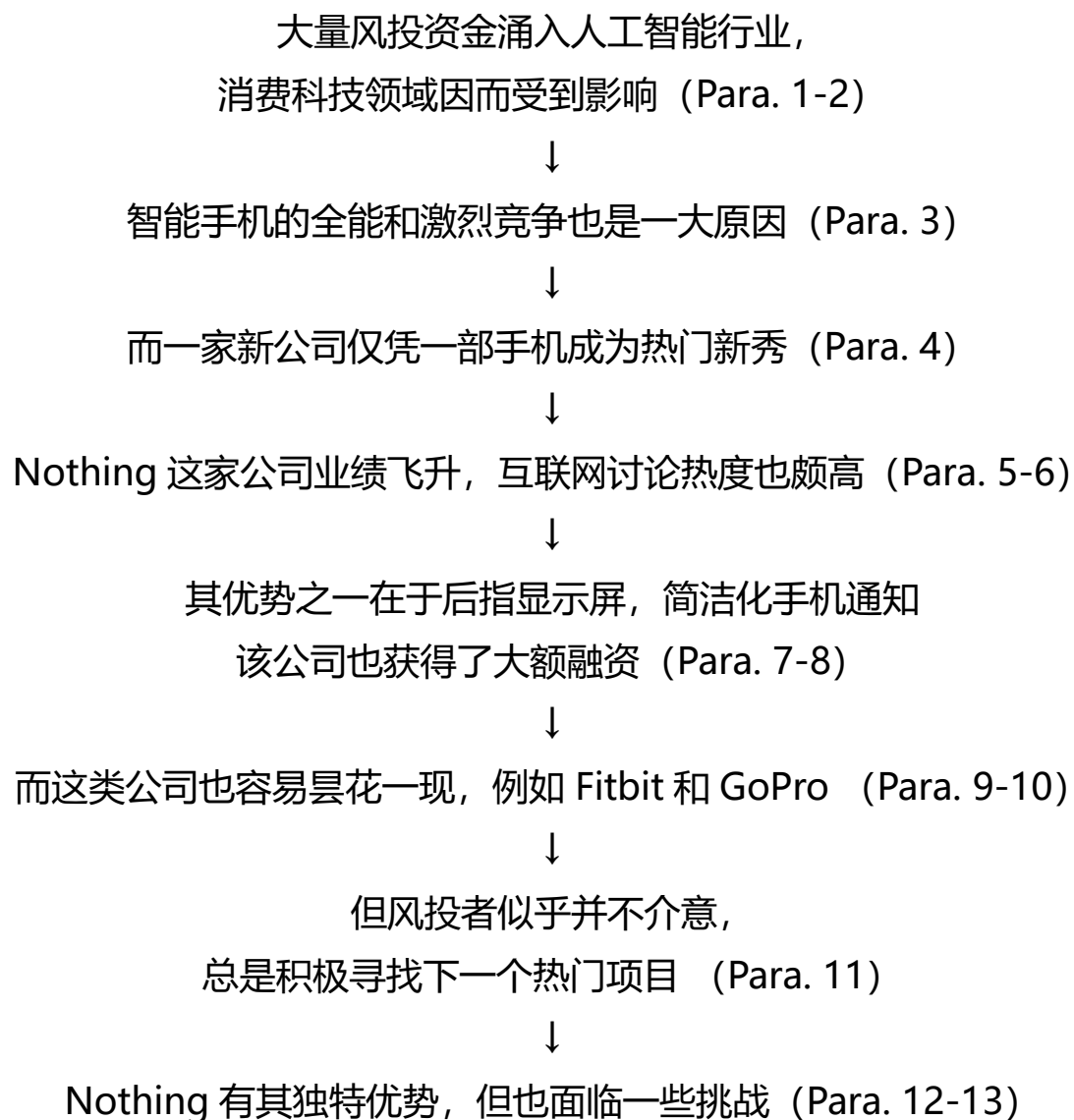


**【9.16| BARRON'S】 This Start-Up Is More Something Than
Nothing **Nothing: 不可小觑的新秀****

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

【考研那些事儿之商业系列】

今日文章脉络:



【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

Artificial intelligence has **upended** Wall Street, **Main Street**, and every road in between. In Silicon Valley, **venture** capital dollars are **rushing** to find AI targets, with total venture funding **surging** to \$256 billion in the first quarter of 2026, according to PitchBook, **surpassing** the 2025 total.

- **upend v.** If you upend something, you turn it upside down.

颠倒【考研大纲词汇】

He upended the beer, and swallowed. 他把啤酒倒出来，大口喝了。

- **Main Street n.** [U] typical middle-class Americans 典型的美
国中产阶级

Main Street won't be happy with this new program. 中产阶级不会对这个新计划感到高兴的。

- **venture n.** A venture is a project or activity that is new, exciting, and difficult because it involves the risk of failure.
风险项目；冒险活动【考研大纲词汇】

...a Russian-American joint venture. ...一个俄美合资的风险项

目。

- **rush v.** ~ (sb) (into sth/into doing sth) to do sth or to make sb do sth without thinking about it carefully (使) 仓促行事, 匆忙行事, 做事草率【考研大纲词汇】

We don't want to rush into having a baby. 我们不急着要孩子。

- **surge v.** (of prices, profits, etc.物价、利润等) to suddenly increase in value 急剧上升; 飞涨; 激增【考研大纲词汇】.

Share prices surged. 股价猛涨。

- **surpass v.** /sə'pɑ:s/ (formal) to do or be better than sb/sth 超过; 胜过; 优于【考研大纲词汇】

He hopes one day to surpass the world record. 他希望有一天能刷新世界纪录。

人工智能彻底颠覆了华尔街、普通民众的生活以及两者之间的方方面面。据 PitchBook 数据显示, 在硅谷, 风险投资资金正蜂拥而至, 争相寻找人工智能领域的投资标的, 2026 年第一季度的风险投资总额飙升至 2560 亿美元, 超过了 2025 年的全年总额。

【Para.2】

As with public markets, those AI dollars have **crowded out** other investments, including the once **red-hot** area of consumer tech. After

peaking near 3,000 in 2021, the number of VC deals for consumer tech was cut in half by last year, PitchBook data show, and the figure continues to **slide** in 2026.

- **crowd out v.** to fill a place so that other people or things are kept out 把（其他人或物）排挤在外
- **red hot a. (informal)** new, exciting and of great interest to people 热门的
a red-hot issue 热点问题
- **slide v. ~ (from...) (to...)** to become gradually lower or of less value 逐渐降低；贬值【考研大纲词汇】

Shares slid to a 10-year low. 股价跌到了 10 年来的最低点。

与公开市场一样，这些流向人工智能的资金挤占了其他投资领域，包括曾经炙手可热的消费科技领域。PitchBook 数据显示，消费科技领域的风险投资交易数量在 2021 年达到近 3,000 笔的峰值后，到去年已减半，且这一数字在 2026 年仍在持续下滑。

【Para.3】

Blame the decline on the do-everything smartphone, which fills in as a camera, GPS, digital assistant, calculator, and all **sorts** of other products that once filled the **aisles** of an electronics shop. Jeff Barrington, managing

director at Windsor Drake, tells Barron's that building a consumer tech start-up is **incredibly** challenging. Margins are low, supply challenges are vast, and competition is fierce. "The other thing, too, is that the big Apples, Amazons, and Googles tend to copy or absorb the consumer tech products," he says.

- **sort n.** a group or type of people or things that are similar in a particular way 种类；类别；品种【考研大纲词汇】

SYN kind

'What sort of music do you like?' 'Oh, all sorts.' "你喜欢哪一类音乐？" "噢，哪一类都喜欢。"

- **aisle n.** /aɪl/ a passage between rows of seats in a church, theatre, train, etc., or between rows of shelves in a supermarket (教堂、戏院、火车等座位间或超级市场货架间的) 走道，过道【考研大纲词汇】

an aisle seat (= in a plane) (飞机上) 紧靠过道的座位

- **incredibly adv.** /ɪn'kredəbli/ extremely 极端地；极其

SYN unbelievably

incredibly lucky/stupid/difficult/beautiful 极其幸运/愚蠢/困难/美丽

这一下滑应归咎于当下几乎全能的智能手机——它集相机、GPS、数字助理、计算器以及其他各类产品于一身；而这些产品曾一度填满了电子产品的货架。温莎·德雷克 (Windsor

Drake) 董事总经理杰夫·巴灵顿 (Jeff Barrington) 告诉《巴伦周刊》，创办一家消费科技初创企业极具挑战性。利润率低、供应链问题重重，且竞争异常激烈。“此外，像苹果、亚马逊和谷歌这样的大型企业往往会模仿或收购消费科技产品，”他说。

【Para.4】

That history makes it all the more surprising that one of this year's hottest consumer tech start-ups is **taking on** the establishment with...a phone. Nothing, founded in 2020, began as an **earbud** maker before moving into smartphones and smartwatches. The products have a clean and modern **aesthetic** that has attracted a young audience looking to **break away** from tech giants Apple and Samsung Electronics. Its prices often **undercut** the competition. The Nothing 4a Pro phone with 256GB of storage starts at \$599; a **comparable** iPhone17 goes for \$799.

- **take on v.** If you take someone on, you fight them or compete against them, especially when they are bigger or more powerful than you are. 与 (尤指强于自己的人) 较量
Democrats were reluctant to take on a president whose popularity ratings were historically high. 民主党不愿意与一个支持率创历史新高的总统较量。

- **earbud n.** a small earphone worn in the ear for use with a mobile phone (配合手机等使用的)耳塞

- **aesthetic n.** /i:s'θetik/ The aesthetic of a work of art is its aesthetic quality. (艺术品的) 审美特质【考研大纲词汇】

He responded very strongly to the aesthetic of this particular work. 他对这部作品的审美特质反应十分强烈。

- **break away phrase** to leave a political party, state, etc., especially to form a new one 脱离，背叛（政党、国家等，尤指再组建新的）【考研大纲词汇】

The people of the province wished to break away and form a new state. 该省人民希望分离成立一个新国家。

- **undercut v.** to sell goods or services at a lower price than your competitors 削（价）竞争；以低于（竞争对手）的价格做生意

to undercut sb's prices 以低于对手的价格求售

- **comparable a.** /'kɒmpərəbl/ ~ (to/with sb/sth) similar to sb/sth else and able to be compared 类似的；可比较的【考研大纲词汇】

A comparable house in the south of the city would cost twice as much. 一栋类似的房子位于城南部就要贵一倍的价钱。

鉴于这一背景，今年最热门的消费科技初创公司之一竟仅凭.....一部手机向行业巨头发起挑战，更令人惊讶。成立于

2020 年的 Nothing 最初是一家入耳式耳机制造商，随后进军智能手机和智能手表领域。其产品拥有简洁现代的美学设计，吸引了希望摆脱苹果和三星电子等科技巨头束缚的年轻用户群体。且其定价往往低于竞争对手。配备 256GB 存储空间的 Nothing 4a Pro 手机起价为 599 美元；而配置相当的 iPhone 17 售价为 799 美元。

【Para.5】

The company, which didn't make executives available for interview, crossed \$1 billion in lifetime sales in 2024. Nothing has **garnered** a lot of social-media attention, with Google trends for “Nothing Phone” and “Nothing headphones” both up 500% versus the previous five years.

- **garner v.** /'gɑ:nə(r)/ (formal) to obtain or collect sth such as information, support, etc. 获得，得到，收集（信息、支持等）

SYN gather acquire

该公司其累计销售额于 2024 年突破 10 亿美元大关，但未安排任何高管接受采访。Nothing 在社交媒体上引发了广泛关注，谷歌趋势数据显示，“Nothing Phone”和“Nothing 耳机”的搜索量较过去五年均增长了 500%。

【Para.6】

The company is a regular presence on TikTok, where users **gloat** about their choice of a non-Apple device. Nothing, itself, isn't shy about taking on the tech behemoth. “This is a message to Apple,” said CEO Carl Pei in a video posted to his TikTok account in June. “My name is Carl. I make phones in London. And I’m gonna steal your customers. One bored iPhone user at a time.”

- **gloat** v. /gləʊt/ ~ (about/at/over sth) to show that you are happy about your own success or sb else's failure, in an unpleasant way 扬扬得意；沾沾自喜；幸灾乐祸

SYN crow

She was still gloating over her rival's disappointment. 她仍在为对手的失望而幸灾乐祸。

- **behemoth** n. /'bi:hɪməθ/ (formal) a very big and powerful company or organization 巨头（指规模庞大、实力雄厚的公司或机构）

该公司经常活跃在 TikTok 上，用户们在那里炫耀自己选择了非苹果设备。Nothing 本身也不避讳挑战这家科技巨头。

“这是给苹果的一封信，” 首席执行官卡尔·佩伊（Carl Pei）在 6 月发布于其 TikTok 账号的一段视频中说道，“我叫卡尔。我在伦敦制造手机。我将抢走你们的客户。一次夺走一个厌倦了 iPhone 的用户。”

【Para.7】

In a fairly **commoditized** world of smartphones, Nothing has tried to stand out with at least one unusual feature: a **rear** display through which users can deliver notifications with various symbols and animations. The idea is to keep the phone **facedown**, limiting overall screen time.

- **commoditize** v. =commodify to treat (something) inappropriately as if it can be acquired or marketed like other commodities 使商品化
- **rear** a. /rɪə(r)/ [only before noun] at or near the back of sth 后面的；后部的【考研大纲词汇】
front and rear windows 前面和后面的窗户
- **facedown** adv. 面向下地

在智能手机高度同质化的市场中，Nothing 试图通过至少一项独特功能脱颖而出：后置显示屏，用户可通过该屏幕以各种符号和动画形式接收通知。这一设计旨在让手机保持屏幕朝下的状态，从而减少整体屏幕使用时间。

【Para.8】

Nothing has raised \$456 million, per PitchBook, including a Series C funding round that brought in \$200 million last year, giving the company

a valuation of \$1.3 billion. It's rare air for consumer tech firms. According to PitchBook, of more than 31,000 VC-funded consumertech companies, just 0.4% have generated a \$1 billion-plus exit. Even for those, it's often a tough **go**.

- **go n.** an attempt at doing sth (做某事的) 尝试，一番努力
【考研大纲词汇】

It took three goes to get it right.试了三次才把它弄好。

据 PitchBook 数据显示，Nothing 已累计融资 4.56 亿美元，其中包括去年完成的 2 亿美元 C 轮融资，使该公司估值达到 13 亿美元。这对消费科技公司而言实属罕见。PitchBook 数据显示，在 3.1 万多家获得风投资金的消费科技公司中，仅有 0.4% 实现了 10 亿美元以上的退出。即便是这些公司，发展之路也往往充满艰辛。

【Para.9】

Fitbit, the wearable fitness-tracking device firm founded in 2007, raised about \$66 million in VC funding before going public in 2015 with a \$4.1 billion market value. Six years later, the firm sold itself to Alphabet's Google for half that amount.

Fitbit 是一家成立于 2007 年的可穿戴健身追踪设备公司，在 2015 年以 41 亿美元市值上市前，共筹集了约 6600 万美元

的风险投资。六年后，该公司以半数价格被 Alphabet 旗下的谷歌收购。

【Para.10】

Meanwhile, this past week marked the end of a long **saga** for GoPro, the maker of cameras for outdoor enthusiasts founded in 2002. GoPro went public in 2014 with a market value of \$3 billion, just in time for the smartphone camera to begin **eating into** its sales. For months, GoPro shares have traded below \$1. On Tuesday, the company said it was being acquired by Starman Optical in a \$285 million deal that would expand the business into the “AI data center, government, defense, and **aerospace** markets.”

- **saga** n. a long series of events or adventures and/or a report about them 一连串的事件（或经历）；一连串经历的讲述（或记述）

The front page is devoted to the continuing saga of the hijack. 头版是对劫持事件的连续报道。

- **eat into** v. to use up a part of sth, especially sb's money or time 消耗，花掉，耗费（尤指金钱或时间）【考研大纲词汇】

Those repair bills have really eaten into my savings. 那些修理账单已经耗掉我相当一部分积蓄。

- **aerospace** n. /'eərəʊspeɪs/ [U] the industry of building aircraft and vehicles and equipment to be sent into space
航空航天 (工业); 航空航天技术
jobs in aerospace and defence 航天与国防工作

与此同时，上周标志着 GoPro 一段漫长历程的终结。这家成立于 2002 年的户外运动相机制造商于 2014 年上市，当时市值为 30 亿美元，但恰逢智能手机摄像头开始蚕食其销售额。数月来，GoPro 股价一直徘徊在 1 美元以下。周二，该公司宣布将被 Starman Optical 以 2.85 亿美元收购，此举将使业务拓展至 “AI 数据中心、政府、国防和航空航天市场”。

【Para.11】

Venture capitalists are nothing if not optimists, though. Mark Vena, CEO and principal analyst at SmartTechResearch, tells Barron's that VC investors are currently looking for the next big consumer hardware AI play. He believes that the next consumertech winner will be an AI-powered wearable device that can potentially listen to a person's day-to-day **happenings**, and help with anything from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work.

- **happening** n. /'hæpənɪŋ/ [usually pl.] an event; something

that happens, often sth unusual 事件；发生的事情（常指不寻常的）【考研大纲词汇】

There have been strange happenings here lately. 这儿最近发生了一些怪事。

不过，风险投资家们始终是乐观主义者。SmartTechResearch 的首席执行官兼首席分析师马克·维纳（Mark Vena）告诉《巴伦周刊》，风险投资家们目前正在寻找下一个消费级硬件 AI 领域的热门项目。他认为，下一款消费科技领域的赢家将是一款由人工智能驱动的可穿戴设备，它能够倾听用户的日常生活点滴，并协助处理各种事务，包括安排约会、给亲人发消息，或是提醒用户下班回家路上顺便买买菜。

【Para.12】

The challenge for Nothing will be merging its plain hardware aesthetic—the inspiration for its brand name—with the complications and baggage of AI. According to an August study from the Pew Research Center, 55% of adults under age 30 now say they're more concerned than excited about AI.

Nothing 面临的挑战在于，如何将其简约的硬件美学——这也是其品牌名称的灵感来源——与人工智能的复杂性和历史包袱相融合。根据皮尤研究中心（Pew Research Center）8 月

份的一项研究，目前 55% 的 30 岁以下成年人表示，他们对人工智能的担忧多于兴奋。

【Para.13】

Nothing is betting that audience just needs a different device. “For AI to reach its full potential, consumer hardware must **reinvent** itself,” the company says on its website.

- **reinvent** v. /ˌriːɪnˈvent/ ~ sth/yourself (as sth) to present yourself/sth in a new form or with a new image 以新形象示人；以新形式出现

The former wild man of rock has reinvented himself as a respectable family man. 过去的那位摇滚狂人已经改变形象，成了一位体面的爱家的男人。

Nothing 押注于用户只是需要一款不同的设备。“要让人工智能充分发挥潜力，消费类硬件必须重塑自我，”该公司在其官网上表示。

September 7, 2026 | BARRON'S

正文字数：811 Words

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➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para. 11) He believes that the next consumertech winner will be an AI-powered wearable device that can potentially listen to a person's day-to-day happenings, and help with anything from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 11. He believes that the next consumertech winner will be an AI-powered wearable device that can potentially listen to a person's day-to-day happenings, and help with anything from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work. 他认为，下一款消费科技领域的赢家将是一款由人工智能驱动的可穿戴设备，它能够倾听用户的日常生活点滴，并协助处理各种事务，包括安排约会、给亲人发消息，或是提醒用户下班回家路上顺便买买菜。

主句 宾语从句

He believes that the next consumertech winner will be

主语 谓语 从句主语 系语

an AI-powered wearable device that can potentially

表语 从句主语 谓语

listen to a person's day-to-day happenings, and

宾语 (并列连词)

help with anything

谓语 宾语

from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work.

列举同位语

句子分析：

主句：

主语-He；谓语-believes；

宾语从句：

（引导词）-that；从句主语-the next consumertech winner；系语-will be；表语-an AI-powered wearable device（名词+-powered “由.....驱动的”）；

定语从句，修饰 device：

从句主语-that；谓语-can potentially listen to；宾语-a person's day-to-day happenings（happening 在这里是名词，需要注意）；（连词）-and；谓语-help with（这里可以补译为“协助处理”）；宾语-anything；

列举同位语-from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work（这三个并列的动名

词都是对于 anything 的举例，用于凸显这类设备的功能之广)。

➤ 写作积累

Para.4 That history **makes it all the more** surprising that one of this year' s hottest consumer tech start-ups is taking on the establishment with...a phone.

make it+形容词+that 从句中, it 是形式宾语, 后面的 that 从句才是真正宾语。这种用法主要是为了平衡句子, 因为 that 从句一般都比较长, 更适合放在句尾, 例:

We need to make it clear that it's not just change for change's sake. 我们需要阐明, 这不仅仅是为了改变而改变。

该句中还需要注意 all the + 比较级的用法, 这个表达式会更强调 “更加.....”, 与 even more 的作用相似。例如:

His achievement is remarkable; all the more so because he had no help at all. 他的成就是非同一般; 由于他没有得到过任何帮助, 更显不凡。

Para.6 Nothing, **itself, isn' t shy about** taking on the tech behemoth.

这个句子中同样有强调, 只不过是用 itself 这个反身代词来强调前面的主语 Nothing, 指 “Nothing 这家公司本身并不怯于.....”, 例如: The idea itself is not bad. 这个想法本身并不坏。

而 be shy about 在这里属于拟人修辞，这个短语一般用于指“羞于/害怕做某事”，常用于否定句，例：They are shy about asking for help. 他们不好意思求助。

但需要与 be shy of sth 区分，后者还可以表达“未达到.....”，例：He died before Christmas, only a month shy of his 90th birthday. 他在圣诞节前去世了，仅差一个月就满 90 岁。